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Computer Studies Extension Office

I. **PROJECT TITLE:** Promote Information and Communications Technology by Undertaking Research and Extension Services (**PICTURES**) Integration to Agriculture and Aquaculture Technology Business Incubator (**AATBI**) Project

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III. **RATIONALE**

MSMEs, or micro, small, and medium-sized businesses, are very important to the economy. MSMEs account for more than 99% of all business establishments and 63% of all employment in the nation, producing 40% of the GDP. In light of this, they are called "the backbone of the Philippine economy."

But the COVID-19 epidemic has had a significant impact on this support system. 81% of respondents to a poll by the United Nations Development Programme (UNDP) in 2020 that examined how the crisis affected MSMEs in the nation reported seeing a decline in consumer demand. The lack of financial capacity and constraints in logistics and transportation were the main obstacles MSMEs faced in maintaining operations in addition to the fall in demand.

MSMEs also experienced income losses due to cash flow disruptions and ongoing expenses; according to the survey, 80% of respondents reported a decline in average monthly income from April to June 2020. Although some 20% of the surveyed

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MSMEs attempted to keep their employees and continue paying them in full despite the income losses, 25% of them began to begin terminating workers as a result of the severe impact on cash flow.

MSMEs began using adaptive business methods to counter the negative effects of the COVID-19 epidemic. Digitalization, or the use of internet platforms for company transactions, cost reduction, product and service diversity, the use of non-cash payment choices, and the ability for workers to work from home are a few examples. However, the majority of MSMEs still exist even with these adaptable solutions.

Prospective customers can now access a company's goods or services 24/7 thanks to digital marketing. Digital marketing offers numerous online organic (free) and inorganic (paid) platforms to reach a wider spectrum of clients for businesses that are just getting started. The need for online selling, bartering, and purchasing of goods and services expanded with the emergence of new normal enterprises. Platforms can include email, Facebook, YouTube, SMS, or text messages, as well as affiliate marketing sites like Lazada and Shopee. The presence of these platforms enhances the likelihood of interactions, which should increase revenue. Since start-up companies may need more resources and more technical know-how regarding how to use these platforms, digital marketing will play a vital role in marketing.

The CapSU Dayao Satellite College Computer Studies Department's research and extension banner program, Promote Information and Communications Technology by Undertaking Research and Extension Services (PICTURES), offers various pieces of training using a variety of digital platforms to advertise goods and services and reach a larger audience of prospective clients.

IV. OBJECTIVES

1. Utilize social media as Digital Marketing platforms
2. Develop business websites using Google Sites and Peddlr App.
3. Understand online stores such as Lazada and Shopee.
4. Create a Shopee seller's account.

V. PROJECT DESCRIPTION

For new businesses, the Agri-Aqua Technology Business Incubator offers helpful training. The training process begins with Basic to Advanced Incubation Trainings offered with Modules for the Incubates. The PICTURES research and extension banner program, which includes the computer studies department, is one of the groups of experts and has created training materials and led seminars on digital marketing. As a result, our incubators can make free, organic websites, pages, and an online store with Point of Sale (POS).

Before the advent of such, improved product photographs were taken from prior photography instruction. The chosen resources, which included text,

a company profile, a logo, and product images, served as inputs for the digital marketing training. They know the fundamental concepts underpinning several web platforms, each with benefits and drawbacks.

VI. RESULTS OF INTERVENTIONS

Although most participants needed additional technical knowledge, the AATBI gave them access to partner staff who helped them with their outputs. Family members, who were part of the business and have a computer background, were part of the training to help develop such different online platforms and Point of Sale (POS). They were able to promote their business online, particularly in Facebook Page, Google Sites, and Peddlr App, thus attracting and engaging potential buyers and customers.

VII. LESSONS LEARNED

Incubatee businesses now have access to various Internet venues through digital marketing to market, advertise, and sell goods and services. The creation, upkeep, and improvements call for some level of computer literacy. Additionally, it calls for care and patience while designing the items to be uploaded to the website, page, and online store and managing customer interactions, inventory, and varied tasks. The incubatees were successful in creating the appropriate websites and pages for their businesses, as well as using an online store and a Point of Sale (POS) by using organic listings (free listings), which are more hands-on than inorganic listings (paid listings).

VIII. RECOMMENDATIONS

Based on the lessons learned and the assessment of the performance of the participants output, the following recommendations are:

1. Incubates may also consider about employing an inorganic listing (paid) to engage more potential clients.
2. Monitor the insights, including analytics on the number of engagements.